Masterkey

The Westlake Village

Buyer's Playbook

Your step-by-step guide to buying a home in Westlake Village with confidence.

$1.6M	+18.9%	6.11%	35
Median Price Westlake Village	Year-over-Year Price Growth	Current 30Y Mortgage Rate	Median Days on Market

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Why Westlake Village?

Westlake Village is one of Southern California's most prestigious residential communities. With a population of approximately 7,600, this intimate lakeside enclave offers a rare combination of luxury living, natural beauty, and convenient access to Los Angeles. Here's why discerning buyers choose Westlake Village.

Exceptional Schools

The Las Virgenes Unified School District serves Westlake Village with highly-rated schools, including Agoura High School (9/10), White Oak Elementary (8/10), and Yerba Buena Elementary (7/10). These top-performing schools are a major draw for families and support strong long-term property values.

Lake and Outdoor Lifestyle

Westlake Village is anchored by the stunning Westlake Lake, offering residents access to boating, fishing, and waterfront living. The surrounding Santa Monica Mountains provide miles of hiking trails, while world-class golf courses like North Ranch Country Club and Sherwood Country Club define the area's resort-style lifestyle.

Proximity to LA with Privacy

Located just off the 101 freeway, Westlake Village offers a 45- to 90-minute commute to Los Angeles while maintaining the privacy and tranquility of an exclusive community. Entertainment industry executives, tech professionals, and business leaders call this home for its balance of access and seclusion.

Safety and Community

Westlake Village consistently ranks among the safest communities in California. Low crime rates, beautifully maintained streets, and active homeowner associations create a sense of security and pride that is immediately apparent to visitors and residents alike.

Enduring Value

Home values in Westlake Village have appreciated significantly, with the current median at $1.6M and year-over-year growth of 18.9%. The area's limited housing supply, exceptional amenities, and high barriers to entry protect property values even during broader market corrections.

MasterKey Insight

Westlake Village's exclusive character and limited inventory mean homes here rarely sit on the market for long when priced correctly. With a median household income of $180,000 and a community that attracts high-net-worth buyers, demand remains robust even as the broader market stabilizes.

2026 Market Snapshot

Understanding current market conditions is essential before making an offer. Here's where things stand in Westlake Village as of early 2026.

$1.6M	35 Days	98%	6.5 Mo
Median Price Westlake Village	Median Days on Market	Sale-to-List Price Ratio	Months of Supply

Sources: Redfin, Zillow, Realtor.com (data through early 2026)

What Do These Numbers Mean?

Prices have surged. The Westlake Village median home price is $1,600,000, up a remarkable 18.9% year-over-year. At $673 per square foot, the area commands a significant premium reflecting its desirability and limited supply.

Inventory is balanced at higher levels. With 6.5 months of supply, the market is approaching buyer-favorable territory. This gives well-qualified buyers more negotiating room than they've had in years, particularly on homes at the upper end of the price spectrum.

Homes are selling at a measured pace. At 35 days on market, well-priced homes move efficiently but without the frenzied bidding wars of prior years. The 98% sale-to-list ratio confirms sellers are getting close to their asking prices when priced appropriately.

Rates are stabilizing near 6%. The current 30-year mortgage rate of 6.11% is expected to hold steady or dip slightly through 2026. For a luxury market like Westlake Village, many buyers use jumbo loans or significant cash down payments, making rate sensitivity less acute than in entry-level markets.

2026 Forecast

Industry analysts broadly agree: 2026 is a stabilization year, not a crash year. With Westlake Village's strong 18.9% appreciation and a compete score of 48/100 (somewhat competitive), the market offers a window where buyers can take their time without the panic of prior years. Only 8 homes sold in February 2026, underscoring the exclusivity and limited transaction volume that characterize this market.

What This Means for You

Westlake Village's 6.5 months of supply represents the most buyer-friendly environment in recent memory for this luxury enclave. You have more choices and more negotiating leverage than any time since before the pandemic. However, the area's limited housing stock means exceptional properties still move quickly. Work with an agent who knows this micro-market intimately.

The Home Buying Process

Buying a home in Westlake Village is a significant investment. Here's the process broken into 8 clear steps so you always know what comes next.

1

Check Your Financial Health

Review your credit score (aim for 740+ for the best jumbo loan rates), calculate your debt-to-income ratio, and assess your down payment reserves. With a $1.6M median price, most purchases require jumbo financing or significant cash. A MasterKey agent can connect you with trusted lenders experienced in high-value transactions.

2

Get Pre-Approved

A pre-approval letter from a lender shows sellers you're serious and qualified. For Westlake Village's price points, work with a lender experienced in jumbo loans. Strong pre-approvals with proof of funds make your offer stand out in this discerning market.

3

Define Your Priorities

Lake views, golf course proximity, school district, lot size, single-story vs. two-story, gated community, pool. Getting clear on your must-haves vs. nice-to-haves prevents decision fatigue once you start touring homes in neighborhoods ranging from $900K Lake Lindero to $8.9M Trentwood estates.

4

Tour Homes and Research Neighborhoods

Your MasterKey buyer specialist will set up curated showings based on your criteria. We recommend touring 8-12 homes before making an offer to calibrate your expectations. Drive the neighborhoods at different times of day and visit during both weekdays and weekends.

5

Make an Offer

Your agent will run a comparative market analysis (CMA) to determine fair market value, then craft an offer with the right price, contingencies, and terms. With a 98% sale-to-list ratio, well-priced homes sell near asking, but there's room for strategic negotiation.

6 Enter Escrow and Complete Inspections

Once your offer is accepted, you'll enter escrow (typically 30-45 days). During this period: hire a home inspector ($500-$800 for luxury properties), complete the appraisal (ordered by your lender), review all disclosures, and negotiate any repair credits.

7 Finalize Your Loan

Your lender will complete underwriting, order a title search, and prepare closing documents. Jumbo loans may require additional documentation and slightly longer timelines. You'll receive a Closing Disclosure at least 3 business days before closing.

8 Close and Get Your Keys

Sign the final documents at the title company, wire your closing funds, and the deed is recorded with Los Angeles County. Congratulations, you're a Westlake Village homeowner. MasterKey will be there every step of the way and long after you've moved in.

Understanding Your Costs

The purchase price is just one part of the equation. Here's a realistic breakdown of what you'll need to budget when buying in Westlake Village.

Down Payment

Loan Type	Minimum Down	On $1.6M Home	Notes
Conventional	3-5%	**$48K-$80K**	PMI required below 20%
FHA	3.5%	**$56K**	Loan limits may not cover full price
VA	0%	**$0**	Eligible veterans/active military
Jumbo	10-20%	**$160K-$320K**	Required above conforming limit; most common here

Note: Most Westlake Village purchases exceed the conforming loan limit and require jumbo financing. Some buyers opt for 20-30% down to secure the most favorable jumbo rates.

Closing Costs

California buyers typically pay 2-5% of the purchase price in closing costs. On a $1,600,000 home (Westlake Village median), that's roughly $32,000 to $80,000. Excluding prepaids like taxes and insurance escrows, the core costs average about 2.1%.

Item	Details	Typical Cost
Escrow fees	Split 50/50 in SoCal	$2,000-$4,000
Title insurance (lender's)	Required by lender	$1,500-$3,500
Title insurance (owner's)	Seller typically pays in SoCal	Seller's cost

Appraisal	Ordered by lender	$600-$1,200
Home inspection	Strongly recommended	$500-$800
Loan origination fee	0.5-1% of loan amount	$6,400-$12,800
Prepaid taxes and insurance	2-6 months escrowed	$6,000-$18,000
Recording fees	Los Angeles County	$75-$200

Pro Tip: Negotiate Closing Costs

In a market with 6.5 months of supply, buyers have meaningful leverage to ask for seller concessions. Many Westlake Village sellers will contribute toward closing costs to close the deal, particularly on properties that have been on the market for 30+ days. Your MasterKey agent will help structure this into your offer.

Monthly Payment Estimate

Here's what a typical monthly payment looks like on a $1,600,000 Westlake Village home with 20% down at a 6.11% rate (30-year fixed):

Loan amount	$1,280,000
Principal and interest	$7,770/mo
Property tax (est. 1.1%)	$1,467/mo
Homeowner's insurance	$350/mo
HOA (if applicable)	$0-$500/mo
Total estimated payment	**$9,587-$10,087/mo**

Neighborhood Guide

Westlake Village encompasses a range of distinct neighborhoods, each with its own character, price point, and lifestyle. Here's a comparison to help narrow your search.

North Ranch

Median: $1.49M

Balanced market

An expansive, prestigious neighborhood nestled against the Santa Monica Mountains. North Ranch features large lots, custom estates, and access to the North Ranch Country Club. Popular with families seeking space and privacy, with homes ranging from updated 1980s builds to contemporary custom designs.

Westlake (Core)

Median: $1.31M

Moderate market

The heart of Westlake Village, centered around the lake and the Promenade shopping district. A mix of townhomes, condos, and single-family residences offering walkability, dining, and a vibrant community atmosphere. Strong appeal for professionals and downsizers.

Forest Cove

Median: $1.40M

Stable market

A quiet, tree-lined neighborhood known for its family-friendly streets and proximity to top-rated schools. Homes here are well-maintained and range from classic ranch-style to updated Mediterranean. A solid choice for families prioritizing school access and community.

Lake Lindero

Median: $900K

Competitive market

The most accessible entry point into Westlake Village. Lake Lindero offers condos and townhomes alongside single-family homes near Lake Lindero Park. Ideal for first-time luxury buyers or those seeking the Westlake Village lifestyle at a more attainable price.

Morrison Estates

Median: $2.15M

Buyer-leaning market

A premium enclave featuring larger lots and architecturally distinctive homes. Morrison Estates attracts buyers seeking elevated finishes and generous square footage. At this price point, buyers have meaningful negotiation leverage in the current market.

Trentwood

Median: $8.90M

Buyer-leaning market

The pinnacle of Westlake Village luxury. Trentwood features gated estates on expansive lots with panoramic views, resort-style amenities, and absolute privacy. This ultra-luxury segment has limited transactions, making each property essentially unique.

7 Mistakes to Avoid

Even in a market with growing inventory, costly mistakes can derail your purchase. Here are the most common ones we see in Westlake Village.

1

Skipping pre-approval

Without a pre-approval letter, sellers won't take your offer seriously. In Westlake Village's luxury market, proof of funds or a strong jumbo loan pre-approval is essential. Get pre-approved before you start touring.

2

House-hunting without a budget for total costs

Your monthly payment isn't just principal and interest. Property tax, insurance, HOA fees, and maintenance can add $2,500-$3,500/month on a typical Westlake Village home. Budget for the full picture, including the higher maintenance costs that come with luxury properties.

3

Waiving the home inspection

Even on a $2M+ home, never skip the inspection. A $500-$800 inspection can save you from $50,000+ in hidden foundation, roof, pool, or HVAC issues. In today's balanced market, there's absolutely no reason to waive it.

4

Making major purchases before closing

Buying a car, opening new credit cards, or making large purchases during escrow can tank your credit score and derail your loan. This is especially critical with jumbo loans, which have stricter underwriting requirements.

5

Ignoring the neighborhood

A beautiful home in the wrong micro-location is a poor investment. Visit during morning and evening commute times. Check school ratings. Walk the neighborhood. Verify HOA rules. Your agent can pull data on pending developments and any planned construction that could impact views or traffic.

6

Bidding emotionally

In a market with 6.5 months of supply, overpaying because you 'fell in love' is entirely avoidable. Trust the comparable sales data. Your MasterKey agent will run a CMA so you offer based on facts, not feelings.

7

Not understanding contingencies

Inspection, appraisal, and loan contingencies protect you. Removing them to 'win' a bidding situation means you could lose your deposit if something goes wrong. Know what each contingency does before waiving it. In today's market, you rarely need to waive contingencies to be competitive.

Your Next Steps

You've got the knowledge. Now it's time to put it into action. MasterKey combines expert agents with technology to make your home buying experience seamless, transparent, and confidence-building.

1. **Book a Free Buyer Consultation**
   No pressure, no obligation. We'll review your goals, budget, and timeline, then create a personalized search strategy for Westlake Village and its surrounding communities.

2. **Get Connected with a Trusted Lender**
   We work with lenders who specialize in jumbo loans and high-value transactions, getting you pre-approved quickly with competitive rates for Westlake Village's price points.

3. **Start Your Curated Home Search**
   Your dedicated buyer specialist will set up custom searches, schedule private showings, and guide you through every offer and negotiation in this exclusive market.

Meet Your MasterKey Team

MasterKey was built by two brothers who believe buying a home should be powered by technology and guided by expertise. Here's who you'll be working with.

Mark Mathias

Co-Founder / Principal Broker

With a background in SaaS sales leadership and product management, Mark brings a strategic, tech-forward approach to every real estate transaction. His goal: make buying a home in Westlake Village feel effortless.

Michael Mathias

Co-Founder / CTO / Broker

Michael's expertise from leading ad-tech platforms for clients like Google and Nike powers MasterKey's technology-driven approach. He ensures every client gets cutting-edge tools and personalized service.

Ready to Find Your Home?

Visit www.usemasterkey.com/contact to schedule a free consultation or DM us **'BUYGUIDE'** on social media to connect with a Westlake Village buyer specialist.

This guide is for informational purposes only and does not constitute financial, legal, or real estate advice. Market data is sourced from Redfin, Zillow, Realtor.com, and Freddie Mac as of early 2026 and is subject to change. Always consult with qualified professionals before making purchasing decisions. MasterKey is a licensed real estate brokerage in California.